Best Money Making Apps: 15 Best Apps to Earn Money in 2026

Making extra money from your phone has become much easier than it used to be. Today, there are apps that let you earn by completing freelance projects, delivering orders, selling unwanted items, answering surveys, completing small tasks, getting cashback on purchases, and even turning your everyday skills into a side income.

However, not every app that promises easy money is equally useful. Some are designed for occasional rewards, while others can become a genuine side-income source if you are willing to invest time and effort. The important thing is understanding how each platform works and choosing an app that matches the way you want to earn.

In this guide, we have covered the best money making apps for different situations, including apps for beginners, freelancers, shoppers, gig workers, sellers, and people looking for simple ways to earn from their phones. We will also explain how these apps work, which options require skills, which ones are free to use, and what you should check before signing up.



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What Are Money Making Apps?

Money-making apps are mobile applications or online platforms that provide users with different ways to generate extra income or rewards. Instead of having one standard earning method, these apps can use several models.

For example, a cashback app rewards you for purchases you were already planning to make. A survey app pays you for sharing opinions. A freelance platform connects you with customers who need specific skills, while a delivery or gig app pays you for completing real-world tasks.

This difference matters because the phrase “make money with an app” can mean anything from earning a few dollars in spare time to building a substantial side business.

Best Money Making Apps

The right app depends on what you want to do and how much time you can dedicate to it. Some platforms are better for quick, small rewards, while others can provide opportunities for much larger earnings.

Here are some of the best money making apps to consider in 2026.

1. Upwork – Best for Freelance Work

Upwork is designed for people who want to earn money by providing professional services online. Instead of earning points or completing tiny tasks, freelancers can find clients looking for specific skills.

Common categories include writing, graphic design, programming, web development, virtual assistance, marketing, video editing, customer support, translation, and consulting.

The major advantage is that your income can grow with your skills and experience. A person with a specialized skill can potentially earn much more from a single project than they would from dozens of survey tasks.

Upwork can be particularly useful for people who already have a marketable skill or want to build a freelance career from home.

Best for: Freelancers, professionals, writers, developers, designers and virtual assistants.

2. Fiverr – Best for Selling Skills

Fiverr takes another approach to freelancing. Instead of simply browsing job listings, freelancers can create service listings that explain what they offer.

You might create a service for logo design, article writing, video editing, WordPress setup, voice-over work, SEO, social media management or programming.

It can take time to build reviews and attract regular customers, but a strong profile and clear service description can help you establish a freelance business.

Best for: Freelancers who want to sell specific services online.

3. Rakuten – Best for Cashback

Cashback apps can be one of the simplest ways to get something back from purchases you were already going to make.

Rakuten is a well-known example. Users can access participating retailers through the platform and receive cashback when eligible purchases are completed.

The important distinction is that cashback is not the same as income from working. You normally need to make a qualifying purchase first, so spending more simply to earn rewards does not make financial sense.

Bankrate lists Rakuten among its money-making app options and identifies cashback shopping as its primary earning model.

Best for: Regular online shoppers who want to reduce the effective cost of purchases.

4. Swagbucks – Best for Small Tasks and Rewards

Swagbucks combines several small earning opportunities in one platform. Depending on availability, users can earn rewards through activities such as surveys, shopping-related offers, games and other tasks.

This type of platform is generally more suitable for spare-time earnings than replacing a regular income.

The advantage is variety. If one type of task is not interesting, you can look for another available activity. The downside is that individual tasks may provide relatively small rewards.

Best for: Beginners who want multiple simple earning options.

5. TaskRabbit – Best for Local Tasks

If you prefer earning money through physical work rather than completing online surveys, TaskRabbit is a different type of money-making platform.

Depending on location and availability, people can offer services such as furniture assembly, moving assistance, cleaning, handyman work, errands and other local tasks.

Your earning potential depends on the services you offer, your location, demand and the amount of work you accept.

Best for: People who want to earn from local services and practical skills.

6. DoorDash – Best for Delivery Work

Delivery platforms allow people to earn by completing food or other delivery orders. The amount you make depends on factors such as location, available orders, working hours, demand and expenses.

This model is different from cashback or survey apps because you are being paid for completing actual work.

Before using a delivery app as an income source, remember to account for transportation expenses, maintenance, insurance and taxes where applicable.

Best for: People looking for flexible delivery-based side work.

7. Uber – Best for Driving and Delivery

Uber provides earning opportunities through transportation and, depending on location, delivery services.

The flexibility can be useful for people who want to choose when they work. However, gross earnings should not be confused with take-home income. Fuel, maintenance, vehicle depreciation, insurance and taxes can reduce the amount you actually keep.

Best for: Eligible drivers and delivery workers looking for flexible schedules.

8. Ibotta – Best for Grocery Cashback

Ibotta focuses heavily on cashback opportunities connected with shopping. Users can find eligible offers, complete qualifying purchases and receive rewards according to the platform's terms.

This can be useful for people who regularly purchase groceries or household products anyway.

As with other cashback services, the goal should be to earn rewards from planned spending rather than buying unnecessary products just because an offer exists.

Best for: Grocery shoppers and people who frequently buy participating products.

9. Survey Junkie – Best for Paid Surveys

Survey platforms allow users to share opinions in exchange for rewards.

Survey Junkie is one example of this model. The concept is straightforward: users complete available surveys, accumulate rewards and redeem them according to the platform's current options.

Survey apps are generally easier to start than freelancing because they do not require professional skills. However, they should usually be viewed as a source of small supplemental rewards rather than a full-time income.

NerdWallet notes that survey platforms can provide pocket money, while also emphasizing the importance of considering privacy policies and how personal information is used.

Best for: People who want simple tasks they can complete during spare time.

10. Depop – Best for Selling Clothes

Selling apps can turn unused items into extra money.

Depop is particularly associated with fashion and secondhand clothing. Instead of performing tasks for an app, you earn by listing products and finding buyers.

Your results depend on what you have to sell, the condition and appeal of your products, pricing, presentation, shipping and demand.

Best for: People with clothes, accessories and other items to resell.

11. Poshmark – Best for Reselling

Reselling apps provide another way to make money from things you no longer need.

You can photograph products, write descriptions, set prices and communicate with potential buyers. Some users also treat reselling as a small business by sourcing products specifically for resale.

The more professional your listings become, the easier it can be to build a repeatable selling process.

Best for: Clothing sellers, resellers and people clearing out their closets.

12. Prolific – Best for Research Studies

Research platforms can connect participants with academic or market research studies.

Unlike ordinary entertainment apps, these opportunities are generally based around providing information or completing research tasks. Availability can depend on your profile and the studies currently accepting participants.

The number of opportunities can vary, so it is better to consider this type of platform as supplementary income rather than guaranteed daily earnings.

Best for: People interested in paid research participation.

13. Facebook Marketplace – Best for Selling Unwanted Items

Facebook Marketplace can be useful when your goal is to make money from items already sitting around your home.

Furniture, electronics, appliances, clothing, collectibles and other products can potentially be listed for local buyers.

The biggest advantage is that you do not need to develop a new skill before getting started. You simply need something people are willing to buy.

Best for: Selling used items locally.

14. Rover – Best for Pet Services

If you enjoy working with animals, pet-service platforms can turn that interest into a side-income opportunity.

Depending on the services available in your location, opportunities may include dog walking, pet sitting or related services.

This is more work-intensive than a cashback app, but it can provide a more substantial earning opportunity because customers are paying for a service.

Best for: Pet sitters and dog walkers.

15. Google Opinion Rewards – Best for Quick Surveys

Google Opinion Rewards provides short surveys based on available research opportunities. The type of reward can depend on the user's country and platform.

For example, reward structures are not necessarily identical across markets. In India, current sources report Google Opinion Rewards primarily provides Google Play credit rather than unrestricted cash, which is an important distinction for anyone searching for an app that pays directly into a bank account.

Best for: Short surveys and small rewards.

Best App to Earn Money: Which Type Should You Choose?

There is no single best app to earn money for everyone because earning methods are completely different.

If you have professional skills, freelance platforms such as Upwork and Fiverr can give you access to customers willing to pay for specific services.

If you already drive and want flexible work, delivery and rideshare platforms may make more sense.

If you shop regularly, cashback apps can provide rewards without requiring you to learn a new skill.

If you have unused items at home, selling platforms may generate more money from a few transactions than weeks of small survey rewards.

The better question is not simply which app pays the most. It is which app matches your available time, skills, equipment, location and income goal?

Best Apps to Earn Money From Your Phone

Many people search for the best apps to earn money because they want something they can start using from their smartphone.

There are several broad categories.

Earn Through Freelancing

Freelance apps allow you to sell skills rather than spend time completing small tasks. Writing, design, programming, editing, marketing and virtual assistance are examples.

This route normally takes longer to establish but can offer greater earning potential than reward-based activities.

Earn Through Surveys

Survey apps are easy to understand. You answer questions and receive rewards for eligible completed surveys.

However, surveys can have screening questions, limited availability and payout thresholds. NerdWallet specifically notes that survey income is generally better viewed as pocket money rather than a major source of income.

Earn Through Cashback

Cashback apps return part of the eligible spending associated with participating merchants.

This can be useful for reducing the effective cost of purchases, but it should not encourage unnecessary spending.

Earn Through Selling

Selling apps can be surprisingly effective if you have unused electronics, clothes, furniture, collectibles or other products.

The earning potential is based largely on what you sell rather than how many hours you spend inside the app.

Earn Through Gig Work

Gig platforms connect workers with customers who need services. Delivery, driving, cleaning, moving, pet care and local tasks are examples.

These apps generally require considerably more effort than survey or cashback platforms but can provide a more meaningful side-income opportunity.

Apps for Making Money Without Special Skills

Not everyone wants to become a freelancer or start a business.

If you are searching for apps for making money without specialized professional skills, consider platforms based on surveys, cashback, simple tasks, selling unused items or local services.

The easiest option to start is not necessarily the most profitable.

For example, answering a survey might require only a few minutes and no equipment beyond a smartphone. A local delivery job may require a vehicle and several hours of work, but the potential income can be substantially different.

This is why it helps to separate money-making apps into two groups:

Low-effort earning: Surveys, cashback, receipt rewards and small tasks.

Active earning: Freelancing, delivery, driving, local services and reselling.

Best Apps for Making Money as a Freelancer

If you have a useful skill, freelancing is one of the most flexible ways to use an app for income.

Potential services include:

- Writing and editing
- Graphic design
- Website development
- SEO
- Social media management
- Video editing
- Translation
- Virtual assistance
- Data entry
- Programming
- Voice-over work

The major difference between freelance platforms and survey apps is scalability.

Completing another survey generally produces another small reward. Improving a professional skill can allow you to charge more for future projects.

Best Money Making Apps for Beginners

Beginners should avoid choosing an app purely because someone claims it can generate huge amounts of money.

Instead, start with an earning model that you understand.

For example, you could sell unused items, try a legitimate cashback platform, complete occasional surveys or offer a basic skill through a freelance marketplace.

Once you understand how payouts, fees, taxes, customer communication and withdrawal rules work, you can expand into other options.

Starting with one or two platforms is usually easier than downloading ten apps at once.

Best Money Making Apps for Students

Students often need flexible options that can fit around classes and assignments.

Online freelancing can work well if you already have skills such as writing, coding, graphic design, video editing or social media management.

Survey and reward apps may also be suitable for short periods of free time, although they generally offer smaller returns.

Selling old textbooks, electronics, clothing or other unused belongings can also be a practical way to generate one-time income.

The key is to choose something that does not interfere with your primary responsibilities.

Best Money Making Apps for Side Income

Side income usually requires a balance between time and earning potential.

A useful approach is to divide your options into three categories.

Quick and small: Surveys, rewards and cashback.

Moderate effort: Reselling, local services and delivery work.

Higher skill: Freelancing, consulting, content creation and specialized services.

The higher-income categories generally require more skill, time, responsibility or business development.

Best Free Money Making Apps

Many money-making platforms are free to download and use, but “free” does not always mean that you keep 100% of what you earn.

Some platforms may take commissions, charge transaction fees, offer optional subscriptions or deduct service-related costs.

Before joining an app, check:

- Whether there is a registration fee
- Withdrawal requirements
- Platform commissions
- Payment processing charges
- Minimum cash-out amount
- Available payment methods
- Account verification requirements

A platform that has no download fee can still have other costs.

How Do Money Making Apps Actually Pay You?

Different apps use different reward structures.

Some pay directly into a bank account or payment service. Others provide gift cards, store credit, points or cashback.

For example, survey and reward apps frequently use points that must later be converted into a redemption option. Cashback services may release rewards after a purchase has been confirmed.

Freelance and gig platforms typically have a much closer relationship between completed work and actual earnings.

Always check the current payout rules before investing significant time into an app.

Can You Really Make Money With Apps?

Yes, but the amount depends heavily on the app and the earning method.

There is a major difference between earning $5 from surveys, receiving cashback on purchases and making hundreds of dollars from freelance projects.

Current money-making app comparisons generally separate gig work, freelancing, selling, cashback, surveys and passive-reward platforms because their earning models and potential are fundamentally different.

A useful rule is:

The more valuable the work you provide, the greater the potential earning opportunity tends to be.

This does not guarantee a particular income. Demand, experience, location, competition and expenses all matter.

Are Money Making Apps Safe?

Not every app promising easy money deserves your trust.

Before signing up, investigate the company behind the platform and read its current terms. Avoid services that demand unnecessary upfront payments or make unrealistic income promises.

You should also be careful with personal information. Survey and reward platforms may collect information about users, and privacy policies can explain how that information is used. NerdWallet recommends reviewing privacy policies when evaluating survey-for-money services.

Never provide sensitive financial information to an unfamiliar service simply because it promises fast earnings.

Red Flags to Watch For

Be particularly cautious when an app:

- Promises guaranteed large daily income
- Requires a payment before you can supposedly withdraw
- Uses pressure to recruit other people
- Makes vague claims about how earnings are generated
- Hides important fees
- Has unclear ownership or contact information
- Requests unnecessary sensitive information
- Claims you can become rich with almost no work

Legitimate earning opportunities can still have limitations, fees and eligibility requirements. Transparency is more useful than exaggerated promises.

How to Choose the Best App to Earn Money

Before downloading another earning app, answer five questions.

What Do You Want to Earn?

Are you looking for a few extra dollars, regular side income or an opportunity that could become a larger business?

Your answer changes which apps make sense.

How Much Time Do You Have?

If you have only ten minutes occasionally, surveys and cashback may be practical.

If you have several hours every day, freelancing, delivery work, selling or local services may offer more opportunities.

Do You Have a Marketable Skill?

If yes, start by exploring platforms where customers pay for that skill.

A programmer, designer or writer may get considerably more value from selling professional services than spending the same amount of time on surveys.

Are There Upfront Costs?

Check whether you need a vehicle, equipment, inventory, professional software or another expense.

Calculate your actual profit after these costs.

How Can You Withdraw Your Money?

An app is much less useful if its payout method does not work for you.

Check the current withdrawal threshold, payment method, processing time and eligibility requirements.

Money Making Apps vs Side Hustle Apps

The terms are often used interchangeably, but there is a useful distinction.

A money-making app might reward you for small activities, shopping or surveys.

A side-hustle app can help you operate an actual income-generating service or business.

For example, selling products, freelancing, driving, delivery work and pet sitting can potentially develop into ongoing side businesses.

That does not mean every side-hustle app will produce high income. It simply means the earning model is based more directly on providing value to customers.

How to Make More Money With Earning Apps

Using more apps does not automatically mean earning more.

A better approach is to combine complementary earning methods.

For example, someone with a full-time job might use a cashback app for planned purchases, sell unused items occasionally and use a freelance platform for specialized work.

Someone with more free time might combine local gig work with online freelancing.

The goal should be to increase the value of your time rather than simply increase the number of apps installed on your phone.

Common Mistakes People Make

One of the biggest mistakes is believing every app can provide a full-time income.

Another is focusing on advertised rewards instead of actual net earnings.

For example, if an activity takes an hour and produces a small reward, ask whether the same hour could be used to develop a skill, complete freelance work or sell an item.

People also sometimes spend more money than necessary because they are chasing cashback. A discount is only useful when it applies to something you genuinely needed.

Frequently Asked Questions

What are the best money making apps?

The best money making apps depend on how you want to earn. Freelance platforms can suit people with professional skills, gig apps can work for local services and delivery, selling apps can help turn unused items into cash, while survey and cashback apps are generally designed for smaller supplemental rewards.

What is the best app to earn money?

There is no universal best app to earn money. Your skills, available time, location, earning goal and preferred payment method should determine which platform is most appropriate.

What are the best apps to earn money from your phone?

Some options include survey and reward platforms, cashback services, freelance marketplaces and selling apps. The earning potential varies significantly between these categories.

What are the best apps to earn money without investment?

Survey, cashback and some freelance platforms can be started without purchasing inventory or making a large upfront investment. However, always check the current terms because individual platforms may have fees or other requirements.

What apps for making money are good for beginners?

Beginners can start with relatively straightforward models such as selling unused items, cashback, surveys or simple freelance services. The best starting point depends on whether you want passive rewards, occasional income or skill-based earnings.

Are apps for making money legitimate?

Many legitimate apps exist, but not every earning app is trustworthy. Check the company's reputation, payout terms, privacy policy, fees and user requirements before signing up.

Can I make $100 a day with money-making apps?

It is possible for some people to reach substantial daily earnings through work-based platforms, but it should not be treated as a guaranteed result. Freelancing, delivery and other active work can have very different earning potential from surveys and cashback.

Which money-making apps pay real cash?

Some platforms offer cash through supported payment methods, while others use gift cards, points, credits or cashback. Always check the current withdrawal options for your country before joining.

Are survey apps worth using?

Survey apps can be useful for small amounts of extra money during spare time, but they generally should not be treated as a replacement for employment or a skilled side business.

Can I use multiple money-making apps?

Yes, provided you can manage them efficiently and understand each platform's terms. Instead of installing many similar apps, it can be more productive to combine different earning models.

Final Thoughts

The best money making apps are not necessarily the ones that promise the biggest rewards. The right choice depends on how you want to earn.

If you have a professional skill, freelancing can give you a way to sell that skill directly to customers. If you have items you no longer need, selling platforms can turn unused belongings into cash. Cashback apps can help reduce the cost of purchases you already planned to make, while survey and reward apps can provide smaller earnings during spare moments.

For people who want a more active source of side income, delivery, driving, local services and other gig platforms may offer a different path. These options require more time and effort, but they are based on completing real work rather than simply collecting small rewards.

The most important step is to look beyond the headline earning claim. Compare the time required, expenses, fees, payout rules, privacy practices and actual work involved. Once you understand those factors, you can choose the best app to earn money for your own situation rather than simply downloading whichever app makes the biggest promise.